

UNIT 5 · TOPIC 5.2

Global Distribution Systems (GDS)

The global marketplace that connects every seat to every seller.



B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 5: Technology & Trends
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

TOPIC 5.2

Mission Video Briefing



Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 5: Technology & Trends · Topic 5.2



02

TOPIC 5.2

Mission Question



THINK ABOUT IT

What invisible system connects one travel agent to more than 400 airlines?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 5.2

Mission Briefing

1

5.2.1

Definition and overview of GDS

2

5.2.2

Major GDS providers: Amadeus, Sabre, Galileo, etc.

3

5.2.3

How GDS work and integrate with airlines

4

5.2.4

Role of GDS in connecting airlines, agents and passengers



MISSION OBJECTIVES

- Define a GDS
- Compare major providers
- Explain GDS-airline integration
- Evaluate the GDS business model today

Pedagogy: Technology-Based Learning

TOPIC 5.2.1

GDS: A Quick Definition

**Marketplace**

Connects hundreds of airlines to hundreds of thousands of agents.

**Content**

Schedules, availability, fares, hotels, cars, rail.

**Transactions**

Book, price, ticket, change and refund.

**BUILDING ON 1.5**

Unit 1 introduced GDS basics. Here we focus on technology, integration and how the GDS model is changing with NDC.



TOPIC 5.2.1

GDS Scale (Approximate)

3

global GDS groups dominate

400+

airlines on major GDSs

Billions

of transactions per year

TOPIC 5.2.2

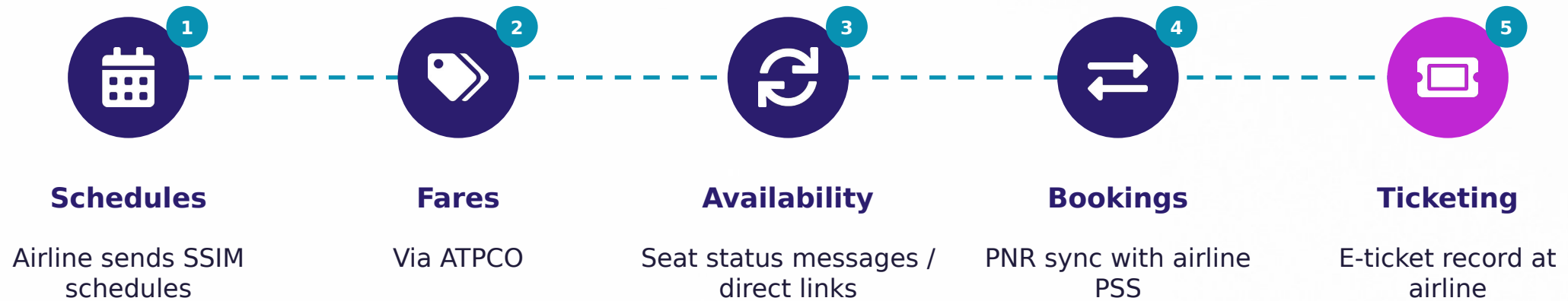
Major GDS Providers

GDS	HQ / origin	Front-end (agent tool)
Amadeus	Madrid, Spain (1987)	Amadeus Selling Platform Connect
Sabre	Texas, USA (1960 SABRE)	Sabre Red 360
Travelport (Galileo, Apollo, Worldspan)	UK/USA	Travelport+ / Smartpoint
Regional systems	e.g., TravelSky (China)	Local agencies



TOPIC 5.2.3

How a GDS Integrates with Airlines



TOPIC 5.2.3

Levels of Connectivity



Standard Messaging

Availability updated by messages; small delays.



Direct / Seamless Access

Real-time availability straight from airline system.



NDC Connection

Airline offers delivered via NDC API inside GDS.

TOPIC 5.2.3

GDS Screen: Graphical vs Cryptic

Same request, two interfaces.

- Cryptic commands are fast for experts.
- Graphical screens help beginners.
- Both hit the same GDS engine.
- Many agents use both.



```
// cryptic (Amadeus-style)
> AN20NOVDELBOM/AAI

// graphical
[From: DEL] [To: BOM]
[Date: 20 NOV] [Airline: AI]
[ SEARCH ]
```

TOPIC 5.2.4

Who Does the GDS Serve?

**Airlines**

Global reach to agents without separate contracts.

**Agents & TMCs**

One screen for all airlines, hotels and cars.

**OTAs**

APIs to power websites and apps.

**Passengers**

Compare and book across airlines.



TOPIC 5.2.4

GDS Business Model



How GDS Earn

- Booking fee per segment from airlines
- Incentives shared with agencies
- Tech and data services

VS



Pressures

- Airlines want lower distribution costs
- NDC and direct channels
- Surcharges on GDS bookings by some airlines



TOPIC 5.2

Innovation Lab: GDS Hands-On Demo



PEDAGOGY

Technology-Based Learning

TIME · 12 min

FORMAT · Pairs, simulator or demo

- 1 Use a GDS training simulator or watch instructor demo.
- 2 Search availability and sell a segment.
- 3 Price the itinerary and view fare rules.
- 4 Compare the result with an OTA for the same flight.



TOPIC 5.2

Click to reveal each answer

System Check Quiz

Q1**Galileo and Worldspan belong to...**

- A) Amadeus
- B) Sabre
- C) Travelport
- D) IATA

ANSWER

C**Q2****Airlines send fares to GDSs mainly via...**

- A) ATPCO
- B) DGCA
- C) BSP
- D) ICAO

ANSWER

A**Q3****GDSs mainly earn from...**

- A) Passenger taxes
- B) Booking fees from airlines
- C) Airport fees
- D) Fuel

ANSWER

B**Q4****Real-time availability from the airline system is...**

- A) Direct/seamless access
- B) Paper
- C) Void
- D) OSI

ANSWER

A

MISSION COMPLETE

Key Takeaways

- ✓ GDS = global marketplace for travel content
- ✓ Big three: Amadeus, Sabre, Travelport
- ✓ Integrates schedules, fares, availability, PNRs and tickets
- ✓ Business model under pressure from NDC and direct sales

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT MISSION

**Topic 5.3 — New
Distribution Capability
(NDC)**

Thank you · Questions?